

Topic 2: Genes and health

This topic begins with a consideration of the structure and functions of the cell membrane and gas exchange surfaces. The structure and properties of proteins, enzyme and nucleic acids lead to the genetic code and protein synthesis. Principles of inheritance, gene therapy and genetic screening are included, giving opportunities for discussion of the social and ethical issues surrounding genetic screening for genetic conditions.

1.2 Assessment information

This unit is assessed by means of a written examination paper, which carries 80 marks, lasts 1 hour 30 minutes and will include:

- objective questions
- structured questions
- short-answer questions

and will also cover:

- *How Science Works*
- practical-related questions.

Students may use a calculator.

The quality of written communication will be assessed in the context of this unit through questions which are labelled with an asterisk (*). Students should take particular care with spelling, punctuation and grammar, as well as the clarity of expression, on these questions.